



IIT Madras
B.S. Degree

PRESENTATION SKILLS



*Strategies for
Professional Growth*

WEEK

3



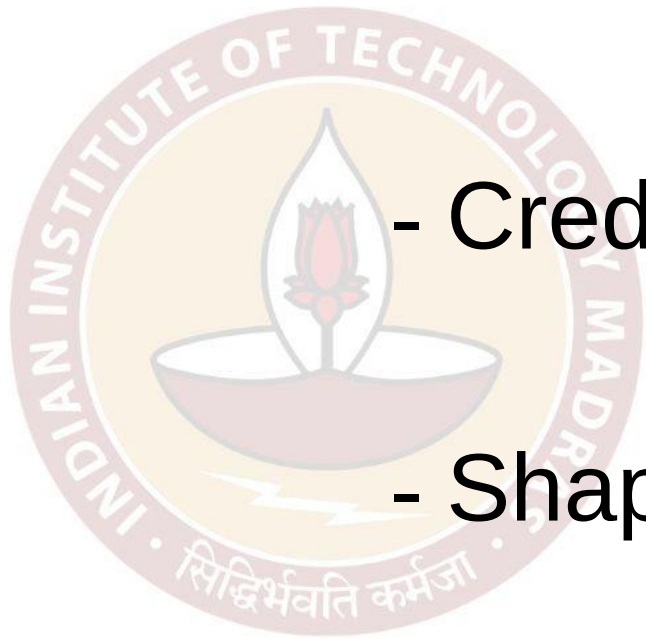
PRATHAP HARIDOSS
PROFESSOR, IIT MADRAS



Writing skills in a professional setting

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Why are writing skills important?



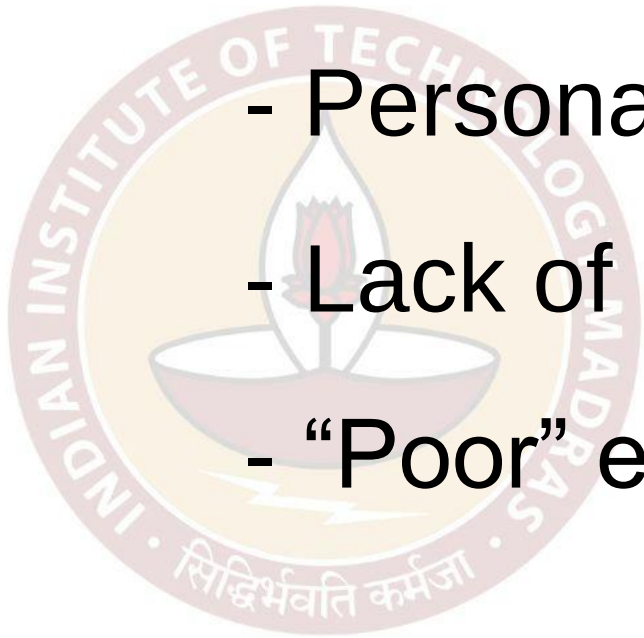
- Credit for your work

- Shaping policy of organization

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Why is formal writing difficult?

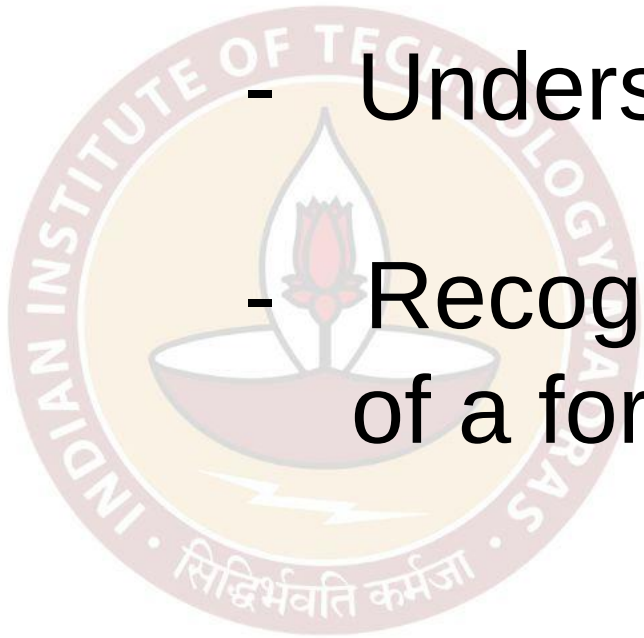
- Personal background
- Lack of knowledge of expectations
- “Poor” examples



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How does one improve?

- Understand the purpose
- Recognize the overall structure of a formal document



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What is the purpose of formal writing?

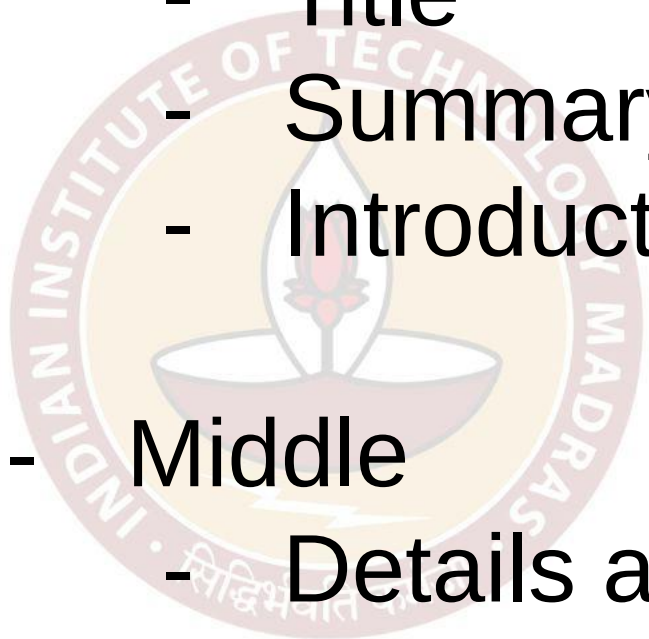


- To inform readers
- To persuade readers

- To do the above efficiently

Overall Structure

- Beginning
 - Title
 - Summary
 - Introduction
- Middle
 - Details and strategy: Chronological, Spatial, flow of variable
- Ending: Summary and Future Perspective



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Language

Use the correct word: Speed Vs Velocity

Be clear - avoid complexity, ambiguity

Functionability, hitherto, discretized

Function, until now, discrete

The patient has an irregular heartbeat and a weak pulse. This is a symptom of low blood pressure.

Language



Be concise – read with sole intent to cut words

At this point in time

now

At that point in time

then

In light of the fact

because

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Language

Avoid arrogant phrases

“it is obvious”

Be familiar - define unusual terms



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Summary

- Writing skills are important
- Formal writing can be challenging
- Recognize the purpose of a formal document
- Understand the structure of a formal document
- Use appropriate language